



*Eris was the least popular of the gods.
She was the goddess of arguments, and chaos
followed her wherever she went.*

For that reason, Eris was the only god not to receive an invitation to the wedding of the mortal King Peleus and the sea nymph Thetis. When Eris learned that she had been left out, she was furious. She decided to crash the wedding and cause mischief.

Eris took a single golden apple with her. On her arrival, she threw it at the feet of three goddesses—Hera, Athena, and Aphrodite. “This apple is for the most beautiful,” she said. She had made sure to throw it in such a way that it was equally close to each goddess. This started a squabble among the three. They could not agree on who should take the apple.

Each goddess thought of herself as the most beautiful.

Usually, Zeus settled fights among the other gods—but this time he did not want to upset any of the goddesses. He decided that a mortal man would be the judge—Paris, Prince of Troy. Zeus took all three goddesses to Paris and handed him the apple. “Paris, give this apple to the goddess you think is the most beautiful,” he demanded.